Measurement of weight:



Weight is the quantitative expression of a body that indicates the state of growth and health. It is measured in kilograms, pounds and grams.

Purposes:

1. To obtain accurate weight of the patient
2. To help in accurate diagnosis of the patient
3. To evaluate patient's response to treatment

Required articles:

1. Weighing scale
2. Newspaper

Guidelines:

1. Weigh on weighing scale when the patient is ambulatory
2. Daily weigh the patient at the same time with the same scale and with same clothing
3. Weigh before meals and after voiding
4. Weigh on admission to provide base line information to subsequent daily weight recording and assess any significant increase or decrease in the patient's weight.
5. The weighing scale must be accurate, hence the balance scale, be prepared before weighing the patient.

Procedure:

1. Collect the equipments
2. Explain the procedure to the patient
3. Wash your hands
4. Assist the patient to void or empty the bladder
5. Check the commonly used flat weighing machines reading is set at zero level
6. Tell the patient to remove the slippers or shoes and extra cloths
7. Assist the patient to step on the centre of the scale platform
8. Assist the patient to step off the scale platform
9. Assist the patient to return to the bed
10. Wash your hands
11. Record the weight in the graphic sheet or nurse's notes.

4.8 BODY MASS INDEX (B.M.I)

BMI is an attempt to quantify the amount of tissue mass (muscle, fat and bone) in an individual, and then categorize that person as underweight, normal weight, overweight, or obese based on that value.

The body mass index is a value derived from the mass (weight) and height of an individual. The BMI is defined as the body mass divided by the square of the body height and is universally expressed in units of Kg/m2 resulting from mass in kilograms and height in meters.

$$BMI = \text{mass}_{kg} / \text{height} m^2$$

Nursing-Voc_Practical_Unit 1-5.indd 283 23-02-2019 3.17.30 PM